PUBLIC-DATA SNAPSHOT — built only from DfE local authority statistics. No data about Seaside Learning or its learners was used.

Prepared for Seaside Learning — the commissioning picture in BCP and Dorset

Demand for alternative and out-of-school provision in Bournemouth, Christchurch and Poole (BCP) and Dorset

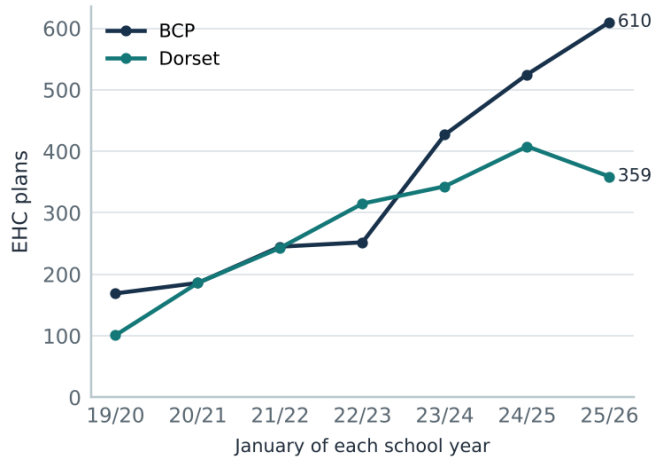
610
BCP EHC plans for children educated outside school, January 2026 (up from 245)

12.2%
of BCP plans, against 8.7% in England

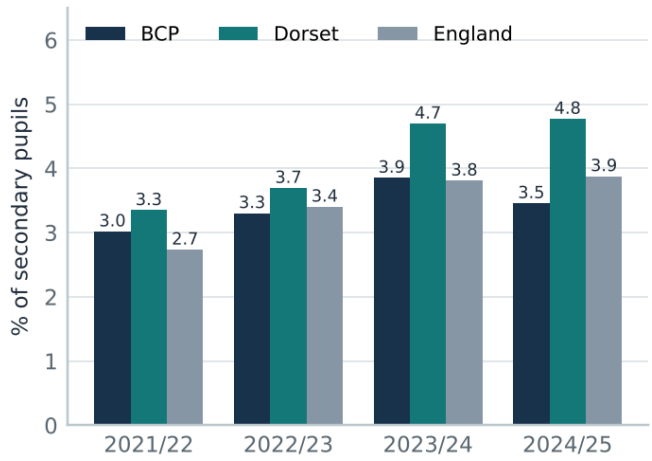
4.8%
Dorset secondary pupils severely absent, 2024/25 (England 3.9%)

+63% / +46%
EHC plans since 2021/22, BCP / Dorset

EHC plans for children educated outside school



Severe absence, state-funded secondary schools



Questions this raises — published data only, so these are questions, not conclusions

1. BCP now has 610 children and young people with EHC plans educated outside school, 12.2% of all plans against 8.7% in England, up from 245 in 2021/22. As placements grow, how long does it take to report attendance and progress back to each school or authority each half-term?
2. Severe absence (missing half or more of sessions) in Dorset secondary schools rose from 3.3% in 2021/22 to 4.8% in 2024/25, above England's 3.9%. Can your reports show each commissioner a young person's attendance against their position at referral?
3. As demand rises faster than budgets, commissioners compare providers on cost and outcomes. Could you show the full cost of a placement, and what it achieves, for each commissioner?

What a Review would add. Published figures show the demand around you. Your own registers show what each school and authority needs, how long the returns take, and where the figures disagree. A Review maps one recurring report in five working days and shows how to produce it once, checked, for every commissioner. The Reporting & Insight Review is £295, fixed price, no VAT, with a full refund if it doesn't give you at least three improvements you'd act on. Details at **zktheory.org/services**.

Sources: DfE Explore Education Statistics — "Education, health and care plans" (as at January each year, to January 2026) and "Pupil absence in schools in England" (state-funded secondary, to 2024/25), downloaded via the DfE statistics API on 29 October 2026. Local authority figures only; no data about any provider or pupil was used.